

# ARCHITECTURE OF PAPER PUBLISHING WITH A FOCUS ON SCOPUS INDEXING

## I. Academic Publishing Ecosystem:

Indexing Database



Publisher



Journal



Volume



Issue



Research Paper

### a) Indexing Database

- The term "indexed" simply means that a journal has been accepted into a recognized indexing database after meeting specific quality requirements.
- Scopus is one of the world's largest abstract and citation databases.
- It does not publish research papers.
- It evaluates journals and includes only those that satisfy its quality standards.
- If a journal is accepted into Scopus, it becomes a 'Scopus-indexed journal'.
- Examples of other indexing database: **Web of Science, PubMed, MEDLINE, Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ)**

### b) Publisher

- A publisher is an organization that manages and publishes academic journals, maintains the journal's website and archives.

- One publisher can manage hundreds or even thousands of journals in different research areas.
- Some well-known academic publishers include: **Elsevier, Springer Nature, IEEE, Wiley, Taylor & Francis, MDPI.**

#### c) Journal

- A journal is a specialized publication dedicated to a particular research field.
- Researchers do not submit papers to the publisher directly.
- Instead, they choose an appropriate journal that matches the scope of their research and submit their manuscript through that journal.
- Examples of journals like: **Applied Energies, Journal of the American Medical Association, African Journal of Food Science and Technology etc.,**

#### d) Volume

- A journal publishes papers continuously over many years.
- Each publication year is generally organized into a Volume.
- For example:  
2023 → Volume 1  
2024 → Volume 2  
2025 → Volume 3

#### e) Issue

- Each volume is further divided into 'Issues' depending on how frequently the journal publishes.
- For example:  
Monthly journal → 12 issues per year  
Quarterly journal → 4 issues per year  
Bi-monthly journal → 6 issues per year

#### f) Research Papers

- Each issue contains multiple research papers.
- Each paper is treated as an independent scientific contribution.

## **II. Additional Information on Scopus Indexing**

- Scopus evaluates journals, not individual research papers.
- A journal applies for evaluation.
- Scopus reviews the journal's quality.
- If accepted, the journal becomes Scopus indexed.
- Future papers published in that journal are included in the Scopus database.
- A journal may be discontinued if it develops problems on its required criteria. So, journals must continuously maintain high standards.

### **a) Main requirements for Scopus indexing**

- Peer review – Papers must be evaluated by qualified experts before publication.
- Regular publication – The journal must publish issues/articles consistently according to its stated schedule.
- Strong editorial board – It should have qualified editors and appropriate subject expertise, with diversity in editorial representation.
- Clear journal information – The journal should clearly state its scope, aims, editorial process and author guidelines.
- Publication ethics – It must follow recognized ethical standards and have policies for issues such as plagiarism, conflicts of interest and misconduct.
- Good quality of published content – The articles should be original, scientifically sound and relevant to the journal's scope.

## **III. Paper Publishing Workflow:**

Research Idea



Research Work



Research Paper



Choose a Suitable Journal



Journal belongs to a Publisher



Submit Manuscript



Editorial Screening



Peer Review



Revision



Acceptance



Publisher Publishes the Paper



If the Journal is Indexed



Paper Becomes Searchable in Databases such as Scopus



Researchers Worldwide Can Read and Cite the Work

-----